WEEK 1 SLATE

Money Mechanics

Seven faceless YouTube Shorts, voiceover-ready. Every runtime is 28-36 seconds, every factual claim is verified, and every hook is anchored on a name the viewer already knows.

The six-beat structure

1	**Hook**	First three words carry a name everyone knows. Zero setup cost.
2	**Setup**	Concrete, fast, specific.
3	**Turn**	The assumption breaks.
4	**Mechanism**	The money machinery, stated plainly.
5	**Name it**	Isolated line, 2-4 words. The highest-value beat.
6	**Loop**	Re-frames the opening on rewatch. Drives completion over 100%.

Delivery

Read at about **3 words per second**. That is a measured rate, not a guess: the 9.8M-view *Survivorship Bias* short runs 62 words in 18 seconds. It is faster than conversational speech and it is meant to be.

House rules

- Cold open. No greeting, no channel name, no 'in this video'.
- No call to action, no outro. End on the loop line and cut.
- Never answer the title in the title.
- Hold one beat of silence after the 'Name it' line.
- Use generic brand-styled graphics, never real logos or real-looking documents.

Posting order

Day	Script	Runtime	Why here
Mon	Wells Fargo took your biggest payment first, on purpose	~33s	Strongest hook, hardest numbers. Lead with your best.
Tue	Elon Musk borrowed $12.5 billion instead of selling one share	~33s	Biggest pre-loaded name on the slate.
Wed	United's loyalty programme was worth more than United	~30s	Hard number in the first six words.
Thu	Banks have a word for people who pay on time	~28s	Personal - everyone watching owns a card.
Fri	The 0% offer that ends in a $1,200 bill	~34s	Rolls into weekend retail mindset.
Sat	Warren Buffett didn't buy insurance companies for the insurance	~35s	Named person carries a quieter concept.
Sun	Toys R Us was profitable when it died	~35s	Strongest emotional close of the week.

MON · SCRIPT 6

Wells Fargo took your biggest payment first, on purpose

~33s · 9 shots · Anchor: Wells Fargo · Concept: High-to-low reordering

HOOK	Wells Fargo took your biggest payment first. On purpose. ON SCREEN **WELLS FARGO**
SETUP	Say you have a hundred dollars and four transactions - three small ones, and your rent. ON SCREEN **BALANCE: $100**
SETUP	In the order they actually happened, you overdraft once. ON SCREEN **1 overdraft = $35**
TURN	Wells Fargo reordered them highest-first, so rent drained the account and all three small purchases bounced behind it. ON SCREEN **REORDERED: HIGH -> LOW**
MECHANISM	One overdraft became four. Thirty-five dollars each. ON SCREEN **$35 -> $140**
MECHANISM	A judge found an internal memo predicting the change would earn them forty million dollars a year. ON SCREEN **INTERNAL MEMO: +$40M / YEAR**
MECHANISM	The court ordered two hundred and three million returned. ON SCREEN **$203,000,000 RETURNED**
NAME IT	**They called it high-to-low reordering.** ON SCREEN **HIGH-TO-LOW REORDERING**
LOOP	It wasn't a glitch. It was the product. ON SCREEN **NOT A GLITCH - THE PRODUCT**

VERIFIED. *Gutierrez v. Wells Fargo, Judge Alsup 2010. High-to-low reordering multiplied overdraft fees; an internal memo projected +$40M/year; $203M ordered returned, final on appeal April 2016.*

TUE · SCRIPT 1

Elon Musk borrowed $12.5 billion instead of selling one share

~33s · 7 shots · Anchor: Elon Musk / Tesla · Concept: Buy. Borrow. Die.

HOOK	Elon Musk pledged sixty-two billion dollars of Tesla stock - to borrow twelve and a half. **ON SCREEN** **$62.5B PLEDGED -> $12.5B BORROWED**
SETUP	He could have just sold shares. But selling triggers capital gains tax - a bite that never grows back. **ON SCREEN** **SELL = TAXED**
TURN	A loan doesn't. Nobody is taxed on borrowed money. **ON SCREEN** **BORROW = NOT TAXED**
MECHANISM	So the stock stays. It keeps compounding. The debt sits underneath it.
MECHANISM	And when he dies, his heirs inherit at the new price, and the original gain is wiped clean. **ON SCREEN** **ORIGINAL GAIN -> ERASED**
NAME IT	**Bankers have a name for it. Buy. Borrow. Die.** **ON SCREEN** **BUY. BORROW. DIE.**
LOOP	Tesla's board eventually had to cap how much he could borrow. That's how well it works. **ON SCREEN** **BOARD CAPPED IT**

> ***VERIFIED.*** *Forbes: $62.5B of Tesla stock pledged against $12.5B in margin loans. Tesla's board later capped pledged borrowing at the lesser of $3.5B or 25% of value. Roughly 236M of his 715M shares remain pledged.*

WED · SCRIPT 3

United's loyalty programme was worth more than United

~30s · 8 shots · Anchor: United Airlines · Concept: The planes are the marketing

HOOK	United's frequent flyer programme was worth more than United.
SETUP	Around twenty billion dollars. The airline itself was priced near seventeen. **ON SCREEN** **$20B PROGRAMME / $17B AIRLINE**
MECHANISM	Because miles cost nothing to make. United invents them, **ON SCREEN** **COST TO MINT: $0**
MECHANISM	sells them in bulk to banks, and the banks hand them to you as credit card rewards. **ON SCREEN** **AIRLINE -> BANK -> YOU**
TURN	Real money in, for a currency they printed themselves. **ON SCREEN** **REAL $ IN <- PRINTED $ OUT**
MECHANISM	We only know the numbers because in 2020 United was desperate and borrowed five billion against it. **ON SCREEN** **2020: $5B LOAN**
NAME IT	**The planes are the marketing.** **ON SCREEN** **THE PLANES ARE THE MARKETING**
LOOP	You're not flying with an airline. You're flying with a bank that owns planes. **ON SCREEN** **A BANK THAT OWNS PLANES**

> ***VERIFIED.*** *United MileagePlus valued at ~$20B (2019) against a ~$17B market cap. United raised $5B against the programme in 2020, which is how the figures became public.*

THU · SCRIPT 2

Banks have a word for people who pay on time

~28s · 8 shots · Anchor: The card industry · Concept: Deadbeat / revolver

HOOK	There is a word banks use for customers who pay their credit card off every month.
NAME IT	**Deadbeat.** ON SCREEN **DEADBEAT**
SETUP	You borrowed their money for thirty days, paid zero interest, and kept the cashback. ON SCREEN **30 DAYS FREE + CASHBACK**
MECHANISM	To them, you are a rounding error. ON SCREEN **PROFIT TO BANK: ~$0**
TURN	The customer they want carries three thousand dollars at twenty-four percent, forever. ON SCREEN **$3,000 @ 24% APR**
MECHANISM	The industry calls that one a revolver. Revolvers are the business. Everyone else is overhead. ON SCREEN **REVOLVER**
NAME IT	**Your rewards are the recruiting budget.** ON SCREEN **REWARDS = RECRUITING BUDGET**
LOOP	Somebody is funding those points. Work out which one of you it is. ON SCREEN **WHO FUNDS YOUR POINTS?**

> ***VERIFIED.*** *'Deadbeat' and 'revolver' are both genuine credit-card industry terms, used exactly this way: deadbeats pay in full and generate little interest revenue; revolvers carry balances and are the profitable segment.*

FRI · SCRIPT 4

The 0% offer that ends in a $1,200 bill

~34s · 8 shots · Anchor: Store card / big-ticket retail · Concept: Deferred interest

HOOK	You owe fifty dollars. The bill says twelve hundred. ON SCREEN **OWED $50 -> BILLED $1,200**
SETUP	Zero percent for twenty-four months, on a two-thousand-dollar sofa. ON SCREEN **0% FOR 24 MONTHS**
SETUP	You paid it almost all the way down, then missed the final payment. ON SCREEN **$2,000 -> $50**
MECHANISM	A normal loan charges interest as you go. ON SCREEN **NORMAL LOAN**
TURN	This one was charging the entire time, invisibly - and only forgives it if you clear every cent before the deadline. ON SCREEN **SHADOW INTEREST, ACCRUING**
MECHANISM	Miss by a dollar, and two years of interest lands at once - calculated on the full two thousand. Not on the fifty you still owed. ON SCREEN **CHARGED ON $2,000, NOT $50**
NAME IT	**It was never zero percent.** ON SCREEN **IT WAS NEVER 0%**
LOOP	You weren't offered a discount. You were offered a deadline. ON SCREEN **NOT A DISCOUNT - A DEADLINE**

> ***VERIFIED.*** *Deferred interest applies retroactively to 100% of the original balance, not the remaining balance. CFPB-flagged as a consumer-harm risk. The $1,200 figure assumes 29.99% APR over 24 months on $2,000 - state that assumption if you put the number on screen.*

SAT · SCRIPT 5

Warren Buffett didn't buy insurance companies for the insurance

~35s · 8 shots · Anchor: Warren Buffett / Berkshire Hathaway · Concept: The float

HOOK	Warren Buffett didn't buy insurance companies for the insurance.
SETUP	Insurers routinely pay out more in claims than they take in premiums - many lose money on the actual business, deliberately, year after year. ON SCREEN **PREMIUMS IN < CLAIMS OUT**
TURN	Because the premium was never the product.
MECHANISM	You pay today. The claim arrives in ten years, or never. ON SCREEN **PAY NOW -> CLAIM IN 10 YEARS**
MECHANISM	In between, they are sitting on a mountain of your money, investing it. ON SCREEN **THE GAP = INVESTED**
MECHANISM	They'll owe most of it back eventually. Every dollar it earns until then is theirs. ON SCREEN **RETURNS -> THEIRS**
NAME IT	**Berkshire Hathaway was built on exactly this. He called it the float.** ON SCREEN **THE FLOAT**
LOOP	He wasn't selling you insurance. He was borrowing from you at less than zero. ON SCREEN **BORROWING BELOW 0%**

> ***VERIFIED.*** *Buffett's own term. Insurers can run an underwriting loss and still profit by investing the premium held between payment and claim.*

SUN · SCRIPT 7

Toys R Us was profitable when it died

~35s · 10 shots · Anchor: Toys R Us / KKR / Bain / Vornado · Concept: Leveraged buyout

HOOK	Toys R Us was profitable when it died. ON SCREEN **PROFITABLE -> DEAD**
SETUP	In 2005, three investment firms bought it for six point six billion. ON SCREEN **2005 - $6.6 BILLION**
TURN	They put in one point three of their own. ON SCREEN **THEIR OWN MONEY: $1.3B**
MECHANISM	The rest was borrowed - and the debt went onto Toys R Us, not them. ON SCREEN **BORROWED $5.3B -> ONTO THE STORE**
MECHANISM	So the company owed four hundred million a year in interest alone. ON SCREEN **$400M / YEAR IN INTEREST**
MECHANISM	Money it couldn't spend on stores, staff, or fighting Amazon. ON SCREEN **NOT SPENT: STORES - STAFF - COMPETING**
MECHANISM	It filed for bankruptcy in 2017. Thirty-three thousand jobs gone. ON SCREEN **2017 - 33,000 JOBS**
TURN	The firms had already taken four hundred and sixty-four million in fees. ON SCREEN **FEES TAKEN: $464M**
NAME IT	**That's a leveraged buyout.** ON SCREEN **LEVERAGED BUYOUT**
LOOP	They didn't buy it with their money. They bought it with its money. ON SCREEN **BOUGHT IT WITH ITS OWN MONEY**

> ***VERIFIED.*** *Acquisition closed 21 July 2005 (KKR, Bain Capital, Vornado) at $6.6B, over $5.3B of it debt-financed. ~$400M/year debt service disclosed at the September 2017 Chapter 11 filing; ~33,000 jobs lost; $464M in fees and interest collected by the three firms. FAIRNESS: a Columbia Law analysis argues retail disruption was the primary cause. The script's narrower claim - that debt consumed the money needed to compete - is the defensible one.*